

I've been sober for 11 years.

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Aug 25, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/Bz3dbI9bzIY> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter compares common alcoholic drinks to their caloric equivalents in whole food meals, arguing that liquid calories from alcohol are a major — and underappreciated — driver of weight gain.

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The Core Argument: Stop Drinking Your Calories 0:00

- The central message is that alcohol contains substantial calories that people tend to overlook
 - Unlike eating a meal, drinking feels effortless and doesn't register as "food" to most people
 - Carter frames this as a key reason people struggle with fat gain despite their diet efforts

Alcohol-to-Food Calorie Equivalents 0:00

- Each alcoholic drink is shown to be calorically equivalent to a real, filling meal or protein source

Alcoholic Drink	Caloric Food Equivalent
Two beers	6 oz chicken breast
One margarita	4 oz sirloin steak + asparagus + side salad
Three rum and Cokes	Turkey sandwich + side salad
Piña colada	5 oz salmon + steamed rice + green beans
Three tequila shots	4 oz lean steak + side salad

- The comparisons are chosen to highlight protein-rich, nutrient-dense meals — the kind of food that would actually keep you full and support muscle retention
 - A single margarita matches an entire balanced plate of steak, a vegetable, and a salad
 - A piña colada alone equals a complete meal of fish, a carb, and a vegetable

The Takeaway: Why This Makes You Fat 0:22

- Carter states directly: "This is one of the reasons y'all getting fat. Y'all drinking the equivalent of this much food every time you go out."
- The implication is that on a night out involving multiple drinks, a person could be consuming the caloric equivalent of several full meals — on top of whatever food they eat
 - These calories are largely invisible because they arrive in liquid form and don't trigger the same satiety signals as solid food
- Carter notes he has been sober for 11 years, positioning himself as someone who has personally eliminated this variable from his diet and fitness routine